Project Management & Leadership Roadmap

Secure & Automated IT Operations Workflow - version 1.1 (revised after independent review)

1. Project Charter

Item	Detail
Project name	Secure & Automated IT Operations Workflow
Sponsor	IT Operations Manager / Head of IT
Project lead	IT Project Lead
Stakeholders	Sponsor (approves baseline, closure); Security lead (policy, incidents); Sysadmin (hosts, automation); Service desk (tickets, users); end users (affected by hardening changes)
Duration	4 weeks (20 working days)
Team	Onboarded IT team members (service desk, sysadmin, junior security)
Purpose	Improve daily IT operations, system documentation and task tracking; establish a secure baseline for Linux (Kali/Ubuntu) and Windows; deliver an automated log-monitoring proof of concept for Linux hosts.

Objectives

1. Standardize daily IT operations through a shared task board, runbooks and a ticket workflow with named owners.
2. Publish and apply a security baseline for Linux and Windows hosts.
3. Deploy a proof-of-concept Python log-parsing and access-validation pipeline on Linux hosts that produces a daily summary report.
4. Establish measurable KPIs (each with a baseline, target, method and review frequency) and a reporting cadence.

In scope: workflow design, documentation, baseline policies, Linux log-parsing automation, team training, KPI tracking. **Out of scope:** procurement of a full SIEM, network redesign, production changes without change approval, **automated log parsing for Windows** (Windows hosts are covered by the baseline checklist audit and manual Event Viewer review of IDs 4624/4625/4720/4732 in this project; automated Windows Event Log parsing is a Phase 2 backlog item).

Success criteria (single definition used in every document):

- *Baseline compliance* = in-scope hosts that pass all Critical and High controls of the baseline checklist, divided by all in-scope hosts. Hosts with a documented, approved, time-limited exception are reported separately and not counted as passing. **Target: >= 90% at Week 4** (>= 95% after phase 2).
- All four objectives delivered by end of Week 4, every team member trained, and the closure criteria in section 5 met.

2. Four-Week Implementation Plan

Week 1 - Discovery & Foundations

Day	Activity	Owner	Output
1	Kick-off, goals, roles, tool access	Project lead	Charter signed off
1-2	Asset & system inventory (hosts, OS, owners); define in-scope host list	Sysadmin	Inventory sheet
2-3	Set up task board (Backlog / Doing / Blocked / Review / Done) and ticket categories, fields and SLAs	Project lead (board); Service desk lead (ticket fields)	Live board
3-4	Documentation standard: runbook template, naming, version control (Git/wiki)	Project lead (author); Sysadmin (reviewer)	Doc template
3-5	Capture KPI baselines (30-day ticket export, current account and host status)	Service desk lead (tickets); Sysadmin (hosts, accounts)	Baseline sheet
5	Sponsor decision: designate the central log host and archive custodian (policy B6)	Sponsor	Decision recorded
5	Week 1 review, risk register v1	Project lead	Risk register

Week 2 - Security Baseline & Process Design

Day	Activity	Owner	Output
6-7	Draft hardening baselines (Linux & Windows)	Security lead (Linux, policy); Sysadmin (Windows)	Baseline policy v1
7-8	Define troubleshooting and incident escalation matrix	Project lead + Security lead	Escalation matrix
8-9	Security awareness guide drafted and peer-reviewed	Security lead (author); Service desk lead (reviewer)	Awareness guide
10	Review with sponsor; approve baseline	Sponsor	Approval (milestone M2)

Week 3 - Implementation & Automation

Day	Activity	Owner	Output
11	**Baseline phishing simulation** (before training, to set the awareness baseline)	Security lead	Click/report rates
11-12	Baseline audit on pilot hosts (2 Linux, 2 Windows)	Sysadmin	Audit findings
12-14	Deploy log-parsing script on the 2 Linux pilot hosts (cron, non-root service account); Windows pilots reviewed manually in Event Viewer	Sysadmin	Daily report (Linux)
14	Validate user access records against the approved list	Security lead	Access exceptions list
15	Awareness training session (60 min) + quiz	Security lead	Attendance log, quiz scores

Week 4 - Rollout, Measurement & Handover

Day	Activity	Owner	Output
16-17	Extend baseline audit to all in-scope hosts; deploy script on all Linux hosts	Sysadmin	Coverage report
18	Tabletop exercise: simulated brute-force incident run through the escalation matrix	Security lead (facilitator); Service desk lead, Sysadmin, IT Ops Manager (participants)	Lessons learned
19	Follow-up phishing simulation; KPI baseline-vs-actual review	Security lead (simulation); Project lead (KPI report)	KPI report
20	Final presentation, retrospective, handover and Phase 2 backlog	Project lead	Closure report

Milestones

Milestone	Date	Gate
M1 Foundations ready	End Week 1	Board, inventory, templates, KPI baselines live
M2 Baseline approved	Day 10	Sponsor sign-off
M3 Pilot automation live	End Week 3	Daily report generated on Linux pilot hosts; training delivered
M4 Closure	End Week 4	KPI report and handover accepted by sponsor

Critical path and schedule float

- **Critical path:** inventory (Day 1-2) -> baseline draft (Day 6-7) -> sponsor approval (Day 10) -> pilot audit (Day 11-12) -> rollout (Day 16-17) -> KPI report (Day 19).
- **Float:** the afternoons of Day 13 and Day 14 (pilot automation is planned for 1.5 days of effort over 3), the afternoon of Day 17, and the morning of Day 20 - about 2 working days in total.
- **If approval slips more than 1 day:** roll out Linux hosts first and move the Windows audit beyond the pilot hosts to the Phase 2 backlog; report this to the sponsor at the Day 15 review rather than extending the schedule.

3. Team Coordination Strategy

Task Delegation

- **Ownership:** every task has exactly one named owner and a due date on the board; helpers and reviewers are named separately and never replace the owner.
- **Matching:** assign by skill and growth need: new members pair with a buddy for their first two weeks.
- **Definition of done:** output documented, peer-reviewed by one other member, linked on the board.
- **WIP limit:** max 3 items "Doing" per person to avoid overload.
- **Priority rule:** P1 security / outage > P2 blocked users > P3 planned project work > P4 improvements.

Daily Sync Protocol (15 minutes, same time daily)

1. Yesterday: what was completed (one sentence each).
2. Today: top 1-3 tasks.

3. Blockers: raised immediately; resolved offline, not in the stand-up.
4. Security / incident watch: any alerts or anomalies from the daily log report (the exit-code-1 alert of the script means SEV-1/SEV-2 findings need review the same day).

Async fallback: written update in the team channel by a fixed time for anyone absent. Weekly (Friday, 30 minutes): review of KPIs, risks and the board. Decisions and actions are recorded in a shared log.

Escalation Procedure (project/work blockers)

Level	Trigger	Who	Time limit
L0	Task blocked	Owner tries to resolve, asks buddy	2 hours
L1	Still blocked	Project lead	Same day
L2	Cross-team / resource issue or schedule risk > 2 days	IT Operations Manager	1 business day
L3	Security incident, data exposure, major outage	Security lead + Sponsor immediately	Immediate

Communication Rules

- Single source of truth: the task board and wiki; no decisions only in private chats.
- Use ticket IDs in every message about an issue.
- Urgent issues by phone/call, not just chat.
- Blameless retrospectives: focus on process, not people.

4. KPI Review Cadence

KPIs are defined with baseline, target, method and frequency in the executive proposal (section 6). Baselines are captured in Week 1 (Day 3-5); progress is reviewed weekly at the Friday review, reported to the sponsor at the Day 15 checkpoint and in the Day 19 KPI report, and afterwards monthly by the run owner.

5. Project Closure Criteria

The sponsor closes the project when all of the following are true:

1. Milestones M1-M4 are delivered and the documents are published in the wiki/repository under version control.
2. The Day 19 KPI report shows baseline versus actual for every KPI, and any missed target has a named owner and plan.
3. Baseline compliance is at or above target, or each non-compliant host has an approved exception with an expiry date.
4. All SEV-1/SEV-2 findings from the pilot and rollout audits are closed or have an owner and due date.
5. Every team member has completed training (attendance logged) and used the escalation process in the tabletop exercise.
6. The daily log report runs on all in-scope Linux hosts and a run owner is named.
7. A Phase 2 backlog exists (Windows Event Log parsing, central log collection, alerting, SIEM

evaluation).